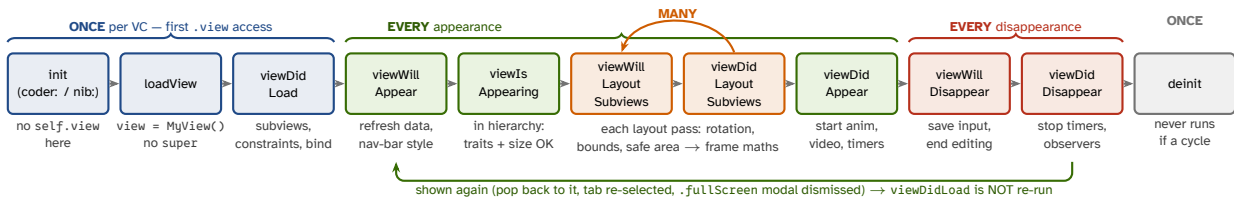


In one line: A VC's view is **lazy**: first access to `.view` runs `loadView` then `viewDidLoad` (**once**); every show runs `viewWillAppear` → `viewIsAppearing` → `layout` → `viewDidAppear`; every hide runs `viewWillDisappear` → `viewDidDisappear`; `deinit` last. The app moves Not running → Inactive ⇌ Active → Background → Suspended, reported per **scene** since iOS 13.



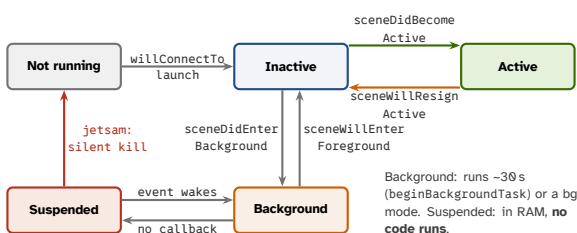
How it works

- loadView** — creates the root view. Default loads the nib/storyboard (or a blank `UIView`). Override *only* for all-code UI; assign view and do **not** call `super`. Never call it yourself.
- viewDidLoad** — in memory, **not** in a window, bounds = nib size: add subviews + constraints, no frame maths.
- viewWillAppear(_:)** — iOS 17 SDK, **back-deployed to iOS 13**. After `viewWillAppear`: view is *in the hierarchy*, trait collection and geometry are accurate. Best place for size/trait-dependent setup per appearance.
- viewWill/DidLayoutSubviews** — every layout pass, also while on screen: keep cheap + idempotent. Always call `super`. Child VCs get callbacks forwarded (`addChild` → `addSubview` → `didMove(toParent:)`).

Example

```
final class FeedVC: UIViewController {
    let table = UITableView(); var timer: Timer?
    override func loadView() { view = table } // no super
    override func viewDidLoad() { super.viewDidLoad(); setUp() }
    override func viewWillAppear(_ a: Bool) {
        super.viewWillAppear(a); reload() // every show
    }
    override func viewDidLayoutSubviews() { // many times
        super.viewDidLayoutSubviews(); gradient.frame = view.bounds }
    override func viewDidAppear(_ a: Bool) { super.viewDidAppear(a)
        timer = .scheduledTimer(withTimeInterval: 5, repeats: true) {
            [weak self] _ in self?.reload() } }
    override func viewWillDisappear(_ a: Bool) { // mirror
        super.viewWillDisappear(a); timer?.invalidate() }
    deinit { print("FeedVC freed") } // proves no leak
}
```

App states — scene-based (iOS 13+)



Launch sequence (cold)

dyld + static init → `main (@main)` → `UIApplicationMain` → `UIApplication` + delegate → `willFinishLaunching...` → `didFinishLaunching...` → `configurationForConnecting` → `scene(_:willConnectTo:options:)` (make `UIWindow`, set root, make `KeyAndVisible`) → `sceneWillEnterForeground` → `sceneDidBecomeActive` → first frame. Watchdog: ~20s (unverified) or killed (0x8badf00d). A **warm** resume skips everything up to `willEnterForeground`.

App delegate vs scene delegate

UIApplicationDelegate = the *process*: `didFinishLaunching`, `configurationForConnecting`, `didDiscardSceneSessions`, `push token`, `applicationWillTerminate` (unreliable). **UISceneDelegate** = one *UI instance* (N per app on iPad): `willConnectTo`, the four hooks in the diagram, `sceneDidDisconnect`. With scenes adopted, `application{DidBecomeActive, WillResignActive,DidEnterBackground, WillEnterForeground}` are **not called**. **SwiftUI**: `@Environment(\.scenePhase) = .active / .inactive / .background` (no "suspended" — no code runs); in App it aggregates all scenes. Bridge with `@UIApplicationDelegateAdaptor`.

Traps

- ! Touching `self.view` in `init` or a setter fires `loadView` + `viewDidLoad` early — before your properties/outlets are set.
- ! Frames in `viewDidLoad` are the storyboard's, not the device's. Use `viewIsAppearing` / `viewDidLayoutSubviews`.
- ! `.pageSheet` / `.automatic` modal (iOS 13 default): the *presenter* gets **no** `viewWillDisappear`/`viewWillAppear` — refresh via a delegate or `presentationControllerDidDismiss`.
- ! Pause a game on `WillResignActive` (control centre, call) — not on `DidEnterBackground`; save on `DidEnterBackground`. Never rely on `willTerminate`: jetsam kills a suspended app silently.
- ! A strong Timer/closure target → `deinit` never runs. Stop it in `viewWillDisappear`.

Child view controllers — the exact calls

```
addChild(child) // calls willMove(toParent:)
view.addSubview(child.view) // + constraints
child.didMove(toParent: self) // YOU call this one
// removing: the mirror image
child.willMove(toParent: nil) // YOU call this one
child.view.removeFromSuperview()
child.removeFromParent() // calls didMove(toParent: nil)
```

Appearance callbacks reach the child automatically (`shouldAutomaticallyForwardAppearanceMethods = true`); a custom container that turns it off calls `beginAppearanceTransition` / `endAppearanceTransition`.

Remember

init · load · DidLoad · Will · Is · (layout)ⁿ · Did — Will · Did · deinit. *Will* = last chance to prepare; *Did* = already happened, safe to act. *Appear/disappear* come in **pairs**: start in one, stop in its mirror.